

FIELD FEATURE · ILLUMINATE RUNG

The Thread Report

What SpecAssay pins to every pull request.

A passing Gate proves the thread holds — but a reviewer still has to read the diff, and a green check quietly borrows credibility for everything in it. So on every PR, SpecAssay posts one briefing: what moved on the Golden Thread, the touched story walked end to end, and the changes that sit *far from the thread*. It **illuminates; it never blocks**.

[See the real PR →](#)

A normal pull request

This walkthrough is a **real PR** on the bundled example app. A developer paid off some tracked debt — `AC-SYNC-02`, the disjoint-field merge — by adding the proof that was owed, and dropped in a small metrics module along the way.

Four files changed:

<code>tests/test_sync.py</code>	adds <code>test_AC_SYNC_02_...</code> — the proof	on the thread
<code>specs/sync/tasks.md</code>	closes the debt task <code>T005</code>	on the thread
<code>src/sync.py</code>	carries <code>@covers AC-SYNC-02</code>	on the thread
<code>src/metrics.py</code>	new — event counters, no mark	far from the thread

SpecAssay changes **nothing** about the PR itself — not its title, not its description, not its diff. It leaves the human's artifact alone and posts a comment beside it. What follows is that comment, verbatim, section by section.

The briefing it pins to it

1

Gate: ● Golden Thread intact · This PR: +1 proven

The whole thread still holds. A passing Gate does not mean "everything is done" — it means nothing *unfinished* is *hidden* at acceptance-criterion altitude. The one-line summary reads the manifest diff: this PR added one proof.

2

WHAT MOVED

● AC-SYNC-02 — tracked-debt → **proven ↑**

The debt was paid. SpecAssay diffs the base manifest against the PR-head manifest. Here one acceptance criterion moved from owed to answered-for: a named test now protects it. Minted IDs, retired IDs, and added carriers show here too.

3

THE THREAD NOW – SYNC

● US-SYNC-01	backlog	
● FR-SYNC-01	backlog	
● AC-SYNC-01	proven	
● AC-SYNC-02	proven	◀ changed

The touched story, walked top to bottom — story, feature, criteria — as it stands *after* this PR, with the moved row flagged. A reviewer sees the whole thread the change lives on, not just the lines in the diff.

FAR FROM THE THREAD

1 changed file sits **far from the thread** — it changed, but nothing in it carries a mark tying it to an intent this PR moved:

```
src/metrics.py
```

This is the whole point. `metrics.py` changed, but nothing in it touches an intent this PR moved. SpecAssay surfaces it for a *glance* — and stops there. A legitimate refactor and unwanted scope look identical from here, so the machine refuses to guess. It hands the reviewer a spotlight, not a verdict.

Why a comment, and never a block

The report never fails the build. That's doctrine, not a limitation — three postures, in increasing intervention and decreasing frequency:

ILLUMINATE — ALWAYS ON

The briefing above. It surfaces what's decision-relevant and renders no verdict. "Far from the thread" lives here.

AFFIRM — OPT-IN

A team can set `offthread_ack: required` to turn the far-list into a one-click human tick before merge. That's a *person's* verdict, gated behind a lightweight config — never the machine's.

REFUSE — RARE, PROVABLE

The Gate blocks only on what it can prove is a defect: a silent acceptance-criterion gap, an invented ID, exact-set drift. Off-thread is not machine-decidable as a defect, so it never earns a refusal.

The machine may only refuse what it can prove is a defect. For the rest, it makes a human look.

And it stays a comment: SpecAssay posts beside your PR, it never edits it. The diff is the record; the Thread Report is the reading glass.

[See it live on PR #1 →](#)

SpecAssay hallmarks the work; Loupe reads the mark.

The Thread Report is the illuminate rung — a briefing on every PR.

GitHub

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